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Devika Bulchandani, Global CEO of Ogilvy, and Piyush Pandey, Chairman-Global Creative and Executive Chairman of Ogilvy India, are part of one of the world's most respected advertising agencies. A part of the £14.43-billion WPP, Ogilvy, across the world, has been the brains behind some of the best advertising campaigns. India is no exception and its work on Asian Paints,

Mondelez, and Pidilite, among others, is testimony to its creative prowess. And New York-based Bulchandani, 54, and Mumbai-based Pandey, 68, are two of the biggest names in the field. The advertising veterans, in an interaction with *Business Today's Krishna Gopalan*, talk about their work, what advertising will look like, the Indianness factor and of course, that word called data and what comes with it. Edited excerpts:

Q: Devika, you are now on an already long and growing list of Indian-origin CEOs in the corner office. And you are not one from the world of technology...

DB: Once a week I get an infographic of that list. Honestly, I would just ignore it and move on. One day, I decided to take a close look at it. I realised it was predominantly tech and then there was Starbucks' CEO or someone from biotech. There was not one name from the creative world, except me! Yes, seeing my name was a moment of pride though I still wonder why I am next to Satya Nadella (CEO of Microsoft) or Sundar Pichai (CEO of Alphabet) since they are at a very different scale. The realisation did set in at that point and that really meant something.

I then started to look for something else... I wanted to know how many of them were clients of ours! While they all have their individual worlds—a lot of them are clients of WPP in some way—I then said to myself, 'I got you all!'. It was my way of not feeling small.

Q: From Amritsar to Welham Girls' School in Dehradun to St. Xavier's College in Mumbai to the University of Southern California and now the big boss at Ogilvy, it has been an interesting ride, hasn't it?

DB: I don't think so hard about it. My son does get a little curious about the whole thing and says, 'Mom, tell me about the journey,' and I keep saying it is too boring and don't want to reflect back in time... Living the moment is also delusional. I think of tomorrow and the best I can do is put one foot forward. People ask me for a five-year plan. I had no idea the pandemic would happen nor did I expect AI... My personality is really about figuring out 'how to get it done'. That means you have a plan but that has to be achievable. If you create these pies in the sky, you cannot get things done. It does drive my son crazy and he wants to know about what it was like for me to grow up in Amritsar and I am not too keen on that part.

Someone asked me what it is like to lead like a woman and I said, 'I have been doing it for a while.' What is becoming more important is to lead like an Indian. I would not have said that, say, 10 years ago.

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